

ADLO INTERNAL EXECUTION ROADMAP

OBJECTIVE

Move Adlo from a strong heuristic finance tracker with emerging intelligence into a trusted, proactive, and increasingly adaptive financial companion.

CURRENT STATE

Foundation that is already working

- manual, receipt, and Gmail capture
- household-aware budgets and feed/detail flows
- queue/review system
- category hierarchy and merchant memory
- item metadata preservation and normalization
- recurring purchase detection
- recurring item history and watch candidates
- insights surface with state, event logging, and first-pass push dispatch

Strategic systems now in flight

- item intelligence
- recurring purchase intelligence
- spending trend intelligence
- insights engine

EXECUTION PRIORITIES

PRIORITY 1: EXTERNAL PRICE OBSERVATION FOUNDATION

Why

This is the missing piece for the recurring purchase value loop.

We can already:

- detect recurring items
- estimate repurchase timing
- identify price spikes and historical baselines

We cannot yet:

- observe current external prices
- compare current market price to user baseline
- trigger proactive "buy soon, it is cheaper now" insights from external data

Scope

Build:

- product_price_observations schema
- ingestion route/service
- comparison layer between watch candidates and observed prices

Outcome

Unlocks:

- proactive savings opportunities
- pre-purchase price watch
- stronger recurring-item value proposition

PRIORITY 2: INSIGHT DRILL-DOWNS AND TRUST

Why

Insights are now visible and event-logged, but only recurring-item insights have a true drill-down surface.

Trend and budget insights still need:

- clearer explanation
- deeper detail
- a better answer to "why am I seeing this?"

Scope

Build:

- trend detail screen
- category-driver detail screen or filtered transaction view
- clearer action mapping from Summary insight cards

Outcome

Improves:

- user trust
- interpretability
- quality of event data from taps and downstream action

PRIORITY 3: NOTIFICATION POLICY AND RANKING

Why

Push and on-screen insight surfaces now exist, but relevance will quickly become the

limiting factor.

Scope

Short term:

- tighten which insight types are eligible for push
- add throttling / cooldown rules
- tune thresholds and ordering

Medium term:

- use event data (shown, tapped, dismissed) to improve ranking

Outcome

Prevents:

- notification fatigue
- noisy insight surfaces
- erosion of trust

PRIORITY 4: ITEM IDENTITY QUALITY

Why

The accuracy ceiling for recurring/item intelligence is still constrained by fuzzy product identity, especially for groceries and produce.

Scope

Improve:

- description-only product matching
- produce and variable-weight normalization
- merchant-aware aliasing
- multi-item recurring selection UX

Outcome

Enables:

- better recurring detection
- cleaner price comparisons
- stronger recommendation quality

PRIORITY 5: TREND INTELLIGENCE EXPANSION

Why

Trend insights are meaningful now, but still early.

Scope

Expand:

- one-off vs recurring attribution
- projected over-budget insights
- category surge and merchant surge signals
- better budget realism guidance

Outcome

Strengthens the "finance companion" value beyond recurring purchases.

PRODUCT SYSTEM MATURITY BY AREA

Expense Capture

State

- Maturing and already valuable

Next

- parser/provenance improvements
- Gmail ops verification
- stronger location resolution

Ideal

- fast, low-friction, high-confidence capture from all channels

Feed / Detail / Queue

State

- Maturing

Next

- better drill-down experiences
- continued detail polish

Ideal

- the canonical place to inspect, edit, explain, and act on financial behavior

Budgets / Household

State

- Stable foundation

Next

- better realism recommendations and monthly guidance

Ideal

- adaptive budgeting informed by actual behavior

Categories

State

- Maturing

Next

- UX clarity and cleanup

Ideal

- mostly automatic, minimally managed taxonomy

Item Intelligence

State

- Emerging and strategic

Next

- identity quality
- external price observations

Ideal

- product-level financial memory and recommendation engine

Insights Engine

State

- Early but real

Next

- deeper drill-downs
- ranking and notification tuning
- richer hybrid insights

Ideal

- adaptive, personalized, explainable financial guidance

NEAR-TERM BACKLOG

Now

1. External price observation foundation
2. Trend / category insight drill-down screens
3. Push policy and insight ranking tuning

4. Gmail production ops verification

Next

5. Better grocery / produce identity

6. Stronger one-off vs recurring attribution

7. Category UX polish

8. Transaction/detail polish

Later

9. Learned ranking / personalization

10. Dynamic watch timing

11. Seasonal / longer-horizon trend intelligence

12. Broader proactive recommendation system

KEY RISKS / WATCHOUTS

1. Push and insight noise can erode trust quickly if thresholds are too eager.

2. Item-level intelligence quality is still bounded by identity quality for messy consumer data.

3. Gmail cron reliability still needs full production verification.

4. Trend thresholds will need continued tuning as real usage broadens.

5. Test-suite open-handle noise remains tooling debt.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

The product should progress in this order:

1. improve data quality

2. improve interpretability

3. improve proactive usefulness

4. improve personalization

That keeps Adlo trustworthy while it grows into the broader adaptive finance companion vision.